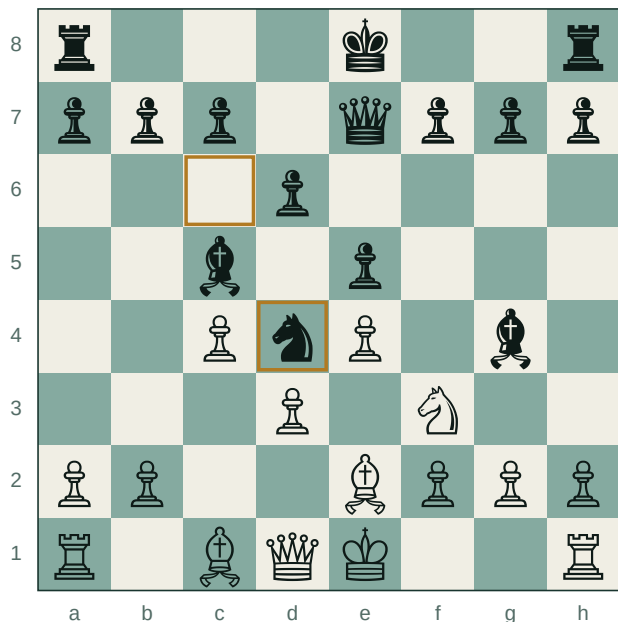


Discovered attacks: White, move 9

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 8...Nd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

9. Nxd4 Bxd4 10. Bxg4

9.Nxd4 The knight captures the knight on d4. The changed line means the bishop on e2 attacks the bishop on g4.
Recorded reply: **9...Bxd4**.

10.Bxg4 The bishop captures the bishop on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 33 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.